Dear students,

Beginning December 4th and 5th, you will make your graded individual presentations. We ask that you follow your teacher's instruction about topic choosing. This assignment is to test your basic speaking skills. These speaking skills include the volume, speed, and clarity of your speech, as well as your physical speaking presence. Are you confident? Relaxed? Do you make eye contact with your audience? You will also be graded on your vocabulary and language use. Remember to keep your presentation conversational! Good speaking, like good writing, makes complicated points simple. It does not make simple points complicated.

You will also be graded (25%) for the content of your presentation. Is it well-organized? Are your main points clear? Is the presentation in logical order? Do you engage the audience? You have the rubric and by now have made a number of practice presentations. You should be getting pretty good at this.

Students should also prepare a PowerPoint or Infographic (PowerPoints are recommended) for your presentation. The visual part of your presentation is 25% of your final grade, so take care to make your information accurate, attractive, and easy-to-read. Proof your visual aids carefully for grammar, punctuation, and spelling.

Your presentation should be about 4 to 5 minutes (followed by a 1-minute Q&A session). You will be penalized for presentations that are less than 4 minutes or longer than 6 minutes. It is up to the individual instructor whether or not to cut you off for exceeding the time limit, or at what point you might be cut off.

All students are expected to dress "business formal" for their presentations. This means, for men, coat and tie (preferably suit and tie, but suits are not mandatory). Women may wear dresses or business suits.

Your presentations will be videotaped and videos archived as part of your academic record. You may request a copy of your presentation from your instructor, but please wait until all performances have been graded. Your presentation will count as 25% of your final course grade.

We know that you have worked hard this semester, and we look forward to watching and listening to your performances.

The First-Year English Teaching Team